area that patriotic congressmen could not refuse, and second such good fortune that the future use of force, if any, was short-lived. Eisenhower twice employed the formula, meeting both requirements, once off the China coast, once in the Middle East. It remained for Lyndon Johnson to employ it in Vietnam.

Of these requirements, Vietnam met the first but missed the second. A naval incident off North Vietnam sufficed for the Tonkin Gulf Resolution, but the use of force proved not to be short-lived. After Americanization of the Vietnam War in the first seven months of 1965, Johnson could have had Congress ratify his decision. Like Truman, he refused. To do so would have meant public acknowledgment that we had entered upon large-scale hostilities likely to last several years. This would have precluded a low-posture, low-visibility approach; it would have precipitated sharp divisions between "hawks" and "doves," subjecting the war effort to intense pressures from each. Moreover, proclamation of sustained hostilities, accompanied by calls for troops and taxes, almost certainly would have delayed or set aside Congressional action on the legislative program for the "Great Society."

As months of war turned into years, however, the President stood alone, a lightning rod for dissent. Having never committed themselves to an American war in Vietnam, members of the Senate and House felt free to attack "Johnson's war." Formally, the Tonkin Gulf Resolution of 1964 may have covered the President's course. Politically, it was a flimsy shield. In considering it initially, the Senate had rejected an amendment stating that Congress did not endorse "extension of the present conflict"; this followed Senator Fulbright's assurance that such an amendment was needless. At the time, President Johnson was opening his campaign for election—against the Republican candidate Barry Goldwater—with word that "American boys should not do the fighting for Asian boys."

Thereafter, once the war had expanded, Congressional disillusion was fueled by a feeling of having been duped. When senators became President Johnson's critics, they tended to attack him sharply and bitterly. Attacks by congressmen helped to legitimate dissent in the country, encouraging others, especially in universities and the media. Moreover, the character of Congressional criticism gave some credibility to charges that the war was not only senseless and immoral, but also illegal. In the end, Johnson's fate, politically, somewhat resembled Truman's.

What does this reading of the recent past suggest about division of warmaking powers between President and Congress? For a nuclear crisis